FREESTONE COUNTY AMATEUR RADIO EMERGENCY SERVICE

TACTICAL MOBILE APP

COMPLETE OPERATOR FIELD MANUAL • MARINE-PROOF EDITION

Step-By-Step Illustrated Visual Instructions for Android & iOS

Cross-Platform Unified Architecture • Build 67 (v7.9.15) • October 2026

COUNTY EMERGENCY COORDINATOR: BRIAN DAVIS (KG5TZT)

Primary Tactical Repeater: 145.110 MHz (-600 kHz, TSQ 146.2 Hz) • County Simplex: 146.580 MHz

Official ARES Field Document • Prepared for Emergency Operations Center & Field Responders

FOUNDATIONAL OPERATIONAL DOCTRINE

THE FOUR GOLDEN RULES OF TACTICAL MOBILE

RULE 1: KEEP PHONE CHARGED & AUDIO VOLUME AT 100%

Emergency alerts, 3-tone siren pages, and incident alarms must cut through vehicle engine noise and adverse weather. Never run tactical operations with phone volume muted or battery below 30%.

RULE 2: OFFICIAL FCC AMATEUR CALLSIGN ONLY

Always identify with your FCC amateur radio callsign (e.g., W5FC, KG5TZT). Never use CB handles, first names alone, or tactical nicknames when signing in or submitting field reports.

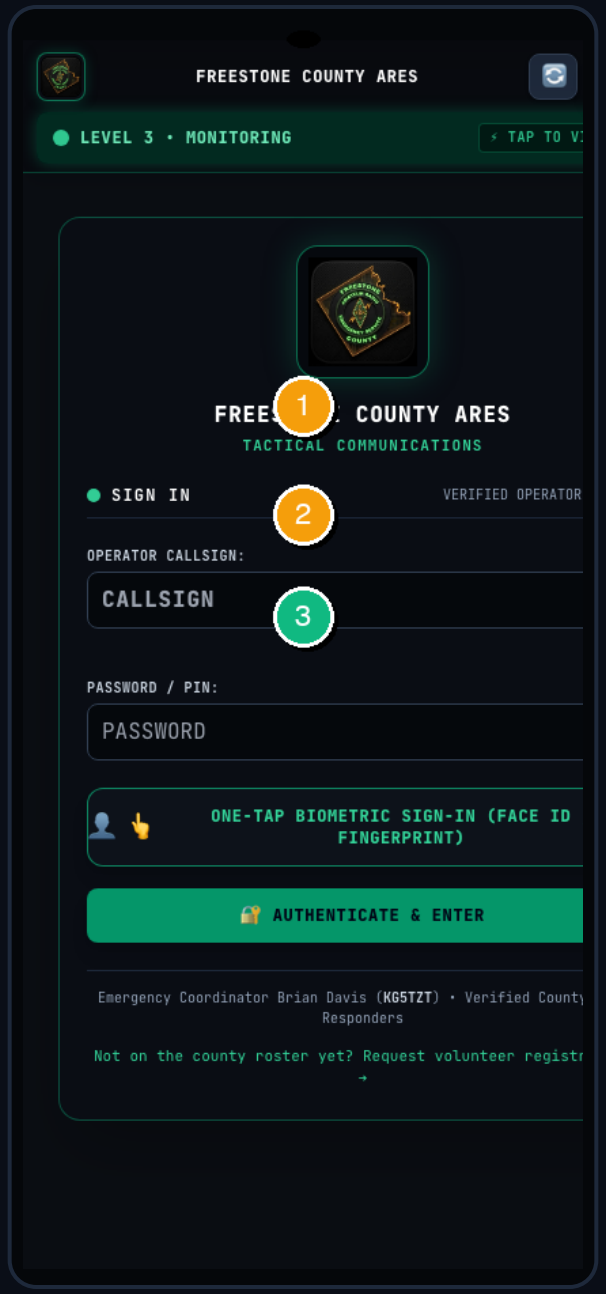
RULE 3: 100% OFFLINE CAPABILITY — ZERO CELL PANIC

When severe weather destroys cell towers, DO NOT PANIC. The tactical app is pre-cached in local phone memory. Your repeaters, maps, field manuals, and ICS forms stay accessible offline.

RULE 4: EVERYONE CAN SITREP — ONLY EC BRIAN DAVIS SETS POSTURE

Any operator can send real-time situational SITREPs silently. Only Emergency Coordinator Brian Davis (KG5TZT) or designated delegates can shift County Activation Levels or sound sirens.

SIGN IN & CLAIM YOUR OPERATOR CALLSIGN



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Identifies who you are on the countywide incident board and unlocks tactical repeaters, rosters, and live field reporting.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Open the app on Android (home screen) or iOS (via Safari / Home Screen).

2. Tap the CALLSIGN box (Badge 1) and type your official FCC Callsign in capital letters.

3. Tap the PASSWORD / PIN box (Badge 2) and enter your volunteer access code.

4. Tap ONE-TAP BIOMETRIC SIGN-IN (Badge 3) to enable Face ID or Fingerprint.

5. Tap the green AUTHENTICATE & ENTER button (Badge 4) to enter the tactical net.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Green confirmation bar flashes and your callsign appears in the top status

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

If you are a new volunteer not yet approved by EC Brian Davis, tap 'Request Volunteer Registration' at the bottom. Your call will go to the EC queue for approval.

THE INCIDENT COMMAND DASHBOARD (HOME BASE)



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Your single pane of glass for county emergency posture, current incident orders, assigned staging locations, and active repeater channels.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Look at Badge 1 (Top Bar): Displays County Posture (Level 1 Routine, Level 2 Standby, Level 3 Active Incident).

2. Look at Badge 2 (Operational Status): Shows active emergency incident title.

3. Look at Badge 3 (Primary PACE Frequency): Shows current designated channel (e.g. FF 110 - 145.110 MHz). Tune your radio here immediately.

4. Check Badge 4 (Clocks): Always use the 24-Hour Central Local Time or Zulu UTC for all incident message logs.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: The dashboard automatically refreshes every few seconds. Live updates bro

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

Whenever an incident is declared, the top bar changes from green to red. Immediately tune your primary VHF radio to the frequency listed under Badge 3.

SUBMITTING A LIVE FIELD SITREP



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Allows any field operator to report real-time observations (road closures, storm damage, flood levels) silently to Net Control without sounding sirens.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

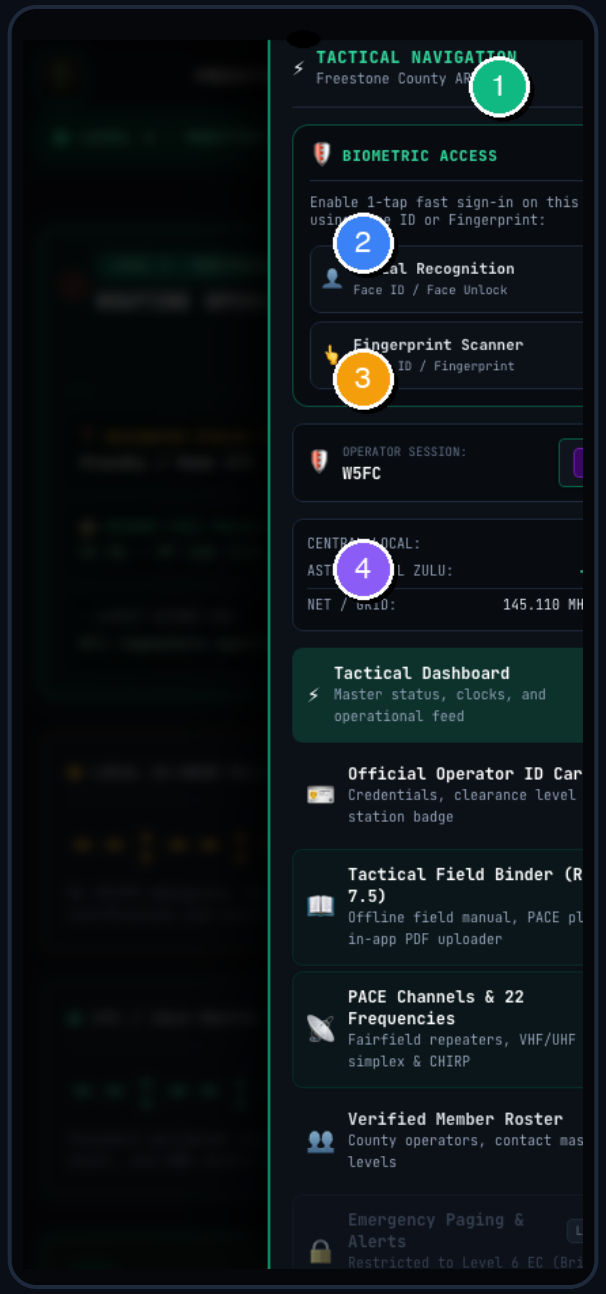
1. **Scroll down on the dashboard to the QUICK FIELD SITREP card.**
2. **Tap the text box (Badge 1) and type your report using facts only (e.g. 'US-84 near Teague: trees across westbound lane').**
3. **Use Badge 2 to clear text if you made a typing mistake.**
4. **Tap the blue SUBMIT SITREP button (Badge 3) to broadcast into the county incident feed.**

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Green success banner appears and your report is added to the live incident

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

Do NOT report rumors or second-hand information. Follow the first-responder rule: 'If you didn't see it with your own eyes, verify it before submitting.'

TACTICAL NAVIGATION DRAWER & BIOMETRIC LOCK



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Provides 1-tap navigation to all 12 operational modules, tactical clocks, Maidenhead grid locator, and biometric unlock settings.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Tap the green 'MENU' button (Badge 1) in the top right corner of any screen.

2. Use Badge 2 to toggle Facial Recognition or Fingerprint Scanner on or off.

3. Check Badge 3 to see synchronized Central Local time, Astronomical Zulu time, and Maidenhead grid square (EM11xq).

4. Tap any menu item in Badge 4 to immediately jump to Frequencies, Maps, Roster, or Manuals.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: The side drawer slides open smoothly from the right side. Tapping 'CLOSE'

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

Enabling Biometric Access lets you unlock the app during nighttime callouts with just your thumb or face, without fumbling to type a password.

OPERATOR ROSTER & DEPLOYMENT CHECK-IN



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Maintains total personnel accountability. Lets Net Control know where you are deployed, your equipment capability, and your safety status.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Tap the green CHECK IN / UPDATE STATUS button (Badge 1) when beginning your shift.

2. Select your current tactical posture from Badge 2 (Available, En Route, On Scene, Staged, or Off-Duty).

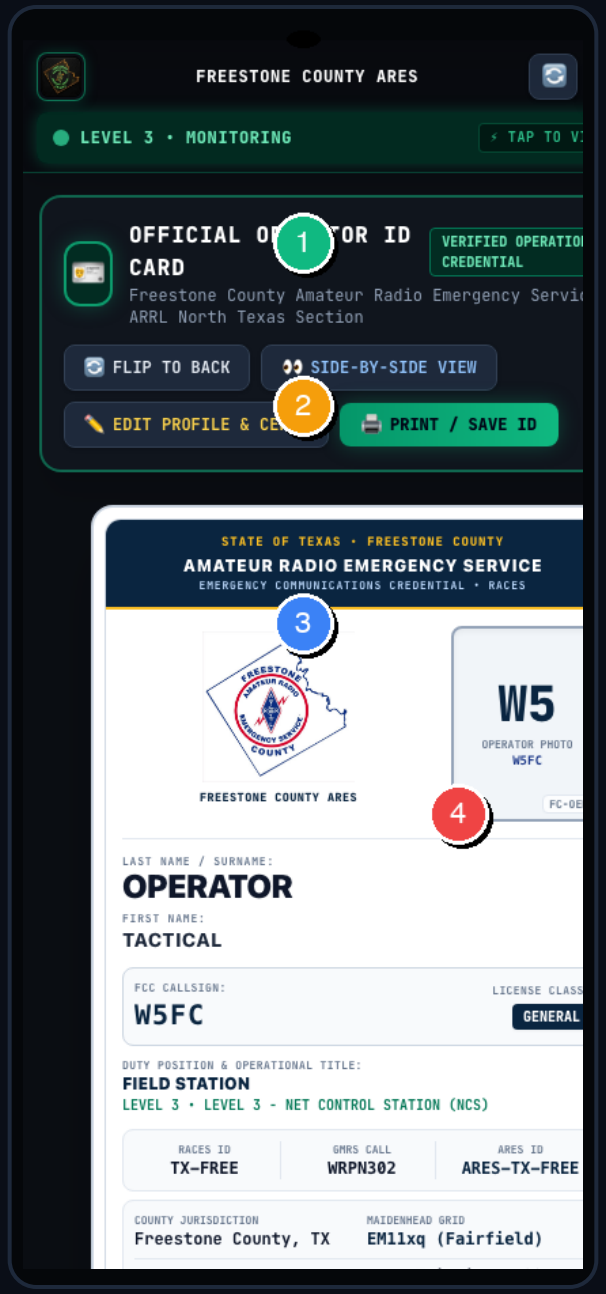
3. Check the verified member list in Badge 3 to see all active operators, contact phone numbers, and tactical assignments.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Your callsign displays an active status badge on the dashboard roster.

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

ALWAYS update your status to 'Off-Duty' when your operating shift is completed so Net Control does not dispatch tasks to an unattended station.

OFFICIAL OPERATOR CAC TACTICAL ID CARD



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Serves as your official digital credential at law enforcement checkpoints, EOC entrances, and designated staging perimeters.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Open the ID Card tab from the menu or dashboard.

2. Badge 1 & 2 display your verified operational credential, FCC callsign, and assigned security clearance level.

3. Present the official barcode / QR scanner box (Badge 3) to checkpoint officers for rapid identity verification.

4. Tap the 'FLIP TO BACK' button (Badge 4) to display your emergency ICE contacts, blood type, and medical notes.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: The card renders in high contrast. Tap 'PRINT / SAVE ID' to save a high-res

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

Make sure your phone screen brightness is at maximum when presenting your digital ID card to officers at night roadblocks.

COMMUNICATIONS PACE PLAN & 22 FREQUENCIES



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Your foolproof guide to county repeater channels, CTCSS tones, offsets, and simplex backup plans following FEMA PACE doctrine.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Check [P] PRIMARY METHOD (Badge 1): Fairfield VHF Repeater (145.110 MHz, -600 kHz, Tone 146.2). This is our main net.

2. Check [A] ALTERNATE METHOD (Badge 2): Wortham VHF Repeater (146.760 MHz, -600 kHz, Tone 136.5). Switch here if Fairfield fails.

3. Check [C] CONTINGENCY METHOD (Badge 3): Countywide Simplex (146.580 MHz Direct). Use if ALL repeaters lose commercial power.

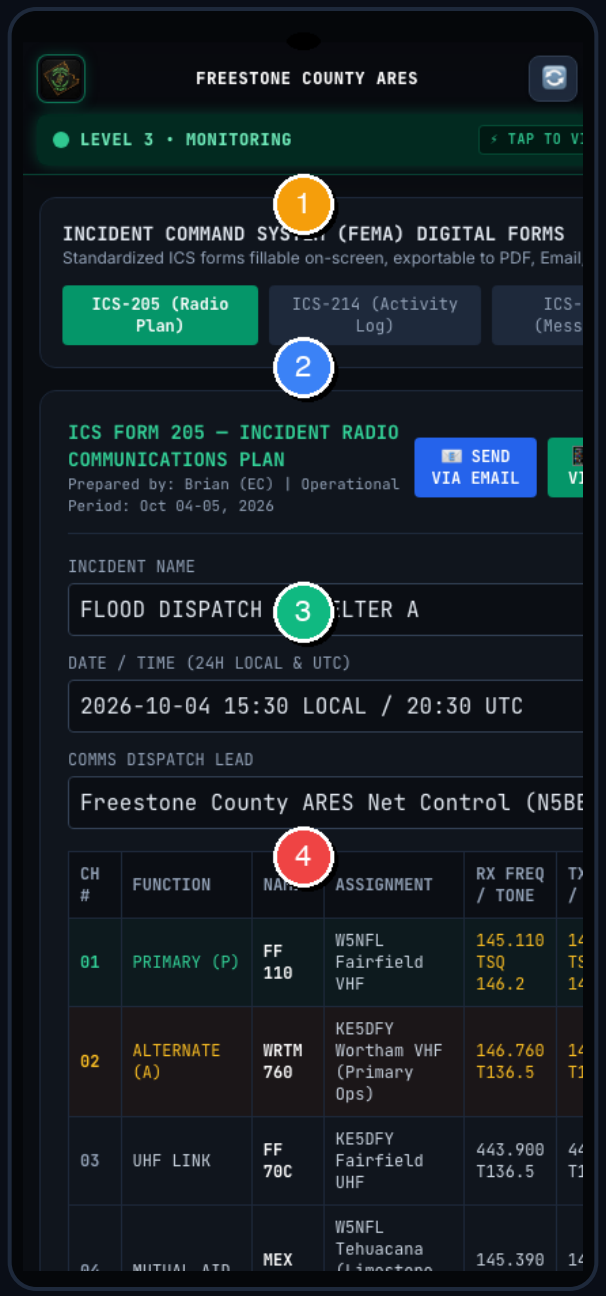
4. Tap 'COPY RX/TX' to immediately copy frequencies to your device clipboard.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Each channel box displays exact transmit/receive frequencies, offsets, and

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

If you hear Net Control declare 'PACE ALTERNATE', switch your radio immediately to Channel 02 (146.760 MHz). Do not stay on primary.

INCIDENT COMMAND (ICS) DIGITAL FORMS



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Standardized emergency message handling. Send ICS-213 General Messages, Radiograms, and Winlink formal traffic with zero errors.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Tap Badge 1 to select the required form: ICS-205 (Radio Plan), ICS-214 (Unit Log), or ICS-213 (General Message).

2. Enter the served agency name, incident name, and TO/FROM routing fields in Badge 2.

3. Type the exact formal message in Badge 3. Keep wording precise and verbatim.

4. Tap 'SEND VIA EMAIL / WINLINK' or 'TRANSMIT' in Badge 4 to route the form.

✔ **HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Forms format automatically to official FEMA NIMS specifications and export**

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

When writing an ICS-213, never edit the wording given to you by served agency officials (Fire Chief, Sheriff, EOC Director). Transmit exactly as written.

SKYWARN SEVERE WEATHER SPOTTER REPORTING



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Direct storm spotter reporting. Sends time-critical ground truth observations directly to Net Control and NWS Fort Worth.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Tap the severe weather hazard icon that matches what you observe (Badge 1): Tornado, Quarter+ Hail, Flash Flood, 58+ mph Wind.

2. Verify your GPS coordinates and observation time in Badge 2 (auto-populated by phone GPS).

3. Tap the red TRANSMIT SPOTTER REPORT button (Badge 3) to log the report.

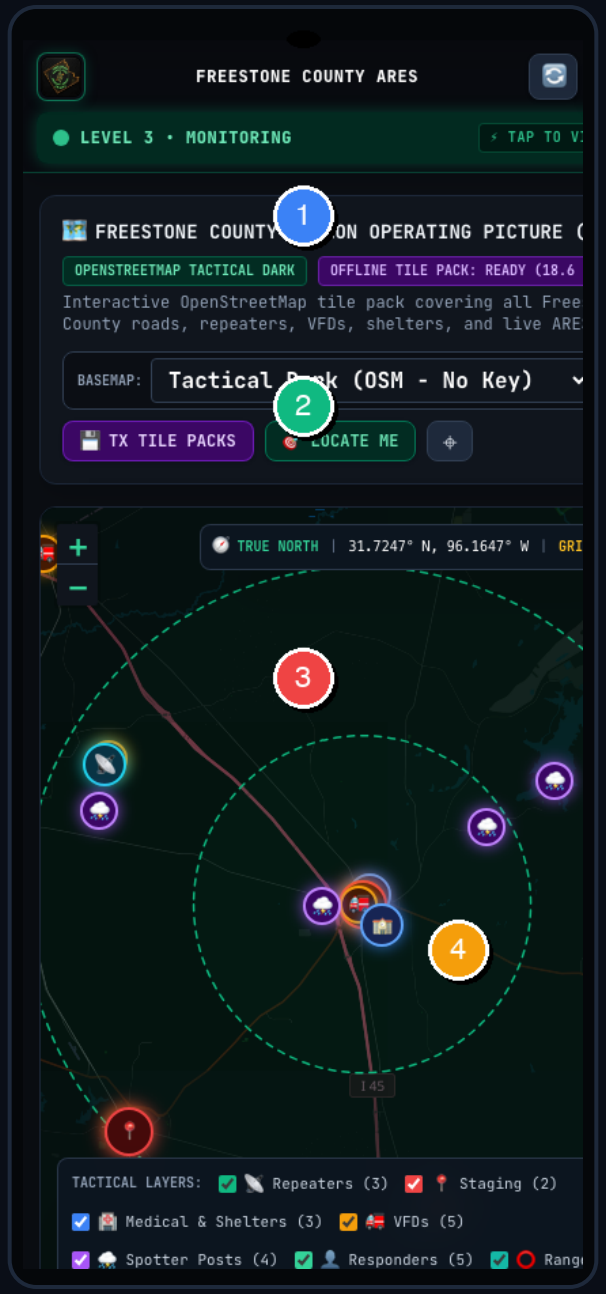
4. Monitor the live NEXRAD County Weather Radar loop (Badge 4) for storm track and reflectivity.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Your report flashes onto Net Control's severe weather board with GPS and ti

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

CRITICAL SAFETY RULE: Never drive into moving water or place yourself in the path of a tornado to make a spotter report. Spot from safety.

OFF-GRID COUNTY TACTICAL MAPS & APRS



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Provides full topographic and road navigation without cellular service, displaying repeater towers, shelters, and live tactical hazard pins.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. The blue beacon (Badge 1) shows your exact real-time GPS location on the county grid.

2. Green and yellow markers (Badge 2) show key infrastructure: Fairfield Tower, Wortham Tower, EOC, Red Cross Shelters.

3. Red markers (Badge 3) highlight active road closures, flooded bridges, and downed power lines.

4. Tap 'DROP TACTICAL PIN' (Badge 4) to mark an obstacle at your current position.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Map tiles are stored in your device offline cache. Zooming and panning work

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

Before deploying into rural parts of Freestone County, open this tab once while on Wi-Fi so all regional map tiles are refreshed in cache.

TACTICAL FIELD BINDER (OFFLINE PDF READER)



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Complete offline access to the official 84-page Freestone County ARES Field Manual, deployment checklists, and radio programming guides.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Tap the CHAPTER JUMP dropdown (Badge 1) to quickly leap to PACE Plans, Winlink setups, or LiFePO4 battery guides.

2. Use the PREV and NEXT buttons (Badge 2) or type a page number to flip through documents.

3. Use the zoom dropdown and fullscreen button (Badge 3) to inspect detailed radio circuit schematics.

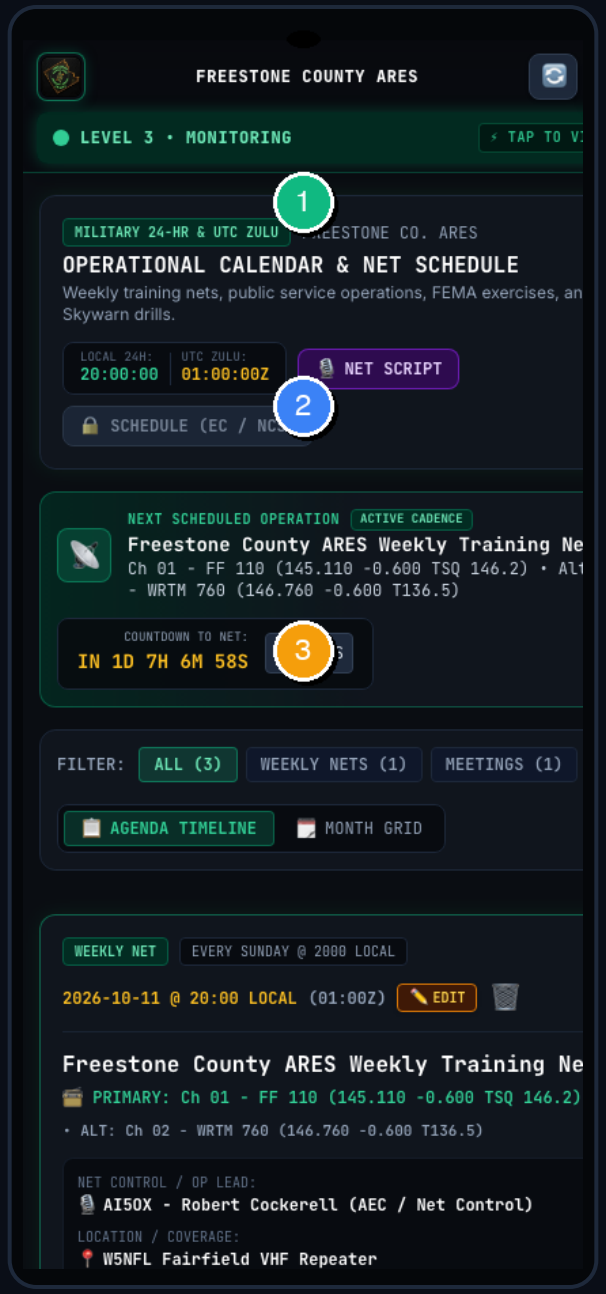
4. Tap 'SAVE PDF' (Badge 4) to download an offline copy to your phone's files folder.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: The built-in PDF viewer renders the complete 84-page manual without needi

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

You can upload a revised Field Manual PDF anytime using the 'UPDATE / UPLOAD MANUAL' button. Revisions save permanently to your phone.

ARES OPERATIONS CALENDAR & TRAINING NETS



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Keeps you informed of upcoming weekly training nets, monthly club meetings, Skywarn spotter classes, and countywide emergency exercises.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Review upcoming weekly training net dates and Net Control Station (NCS) assignments in Badge 1.

2. Review county emergency exercises, SET drills, and public service event dates in Badge 2.

3. Tap 'SYNC TO PHONE' (Badge 3) to automatically export all ARES net times into your Android Google Calendar or iOS Apple Calendar.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Events display exact start times in both Central Local and Zulu time, with

■ MARINE-PROOF FIELD TIP // CAUTION

Freestone County ARES weekly training nets are held every Sunday evening at 2000 Local (8:00 PM) on the Fairfield 145.110 MHz repeater.

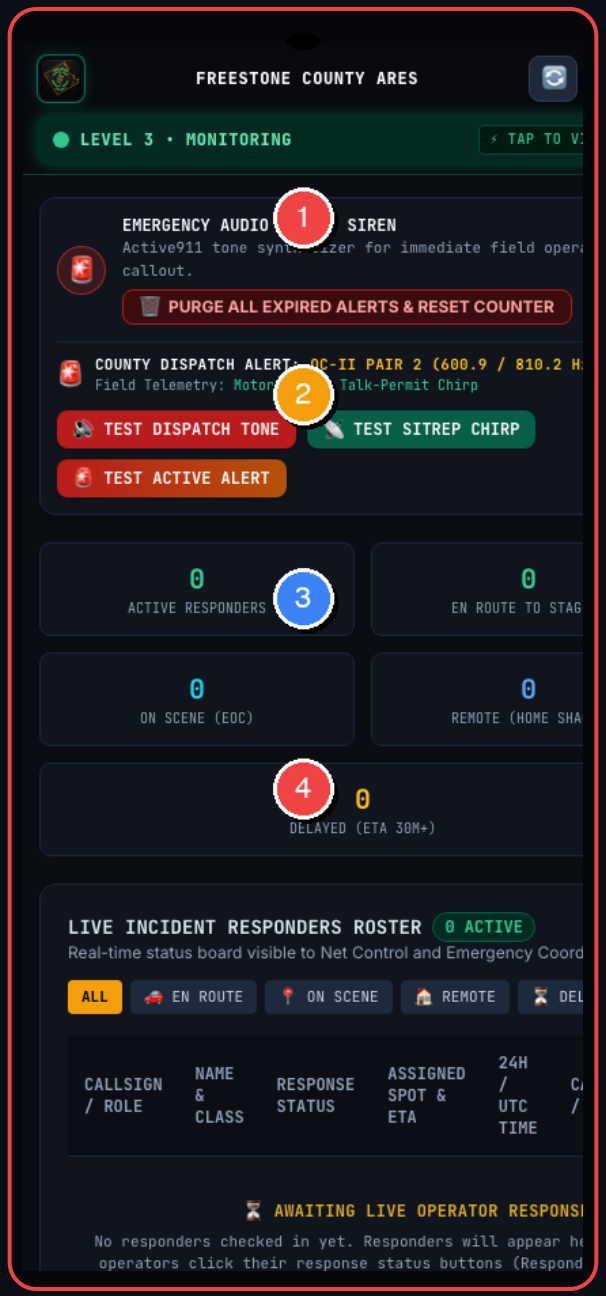
■■ RESTRICTED ACCESS SECTION

APPENDIX: LEADERSHIP & DELEGATED OPERATORS ONLY

The following modules cover Emergency Coordinator administrative authority, County Activation Posture shifts, and Countywide Siren Paging.

Restricted to Emergency Coordinator Brian Davis (KG5TZT) and designated acting delegates.

COUNTYWIDE EMERGENCY PAGING & SIREN BROADCAST



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Transmits immediate piercing acoustic sirens and priority emergency pages to every active operator device in Freestone County.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Select the required siren pattern from Badge 1 (Level 3 Emergency Siren, Standby Chime, or Severe Weather Alert).

2. Test siren tone audio using the buttons under Badge 2 before triggering a live emergency broadcast.

3. Review the active responder board (Badge 3 & 4) to monitor how many operators have checked in as 'En Route' or 'On Scene'.

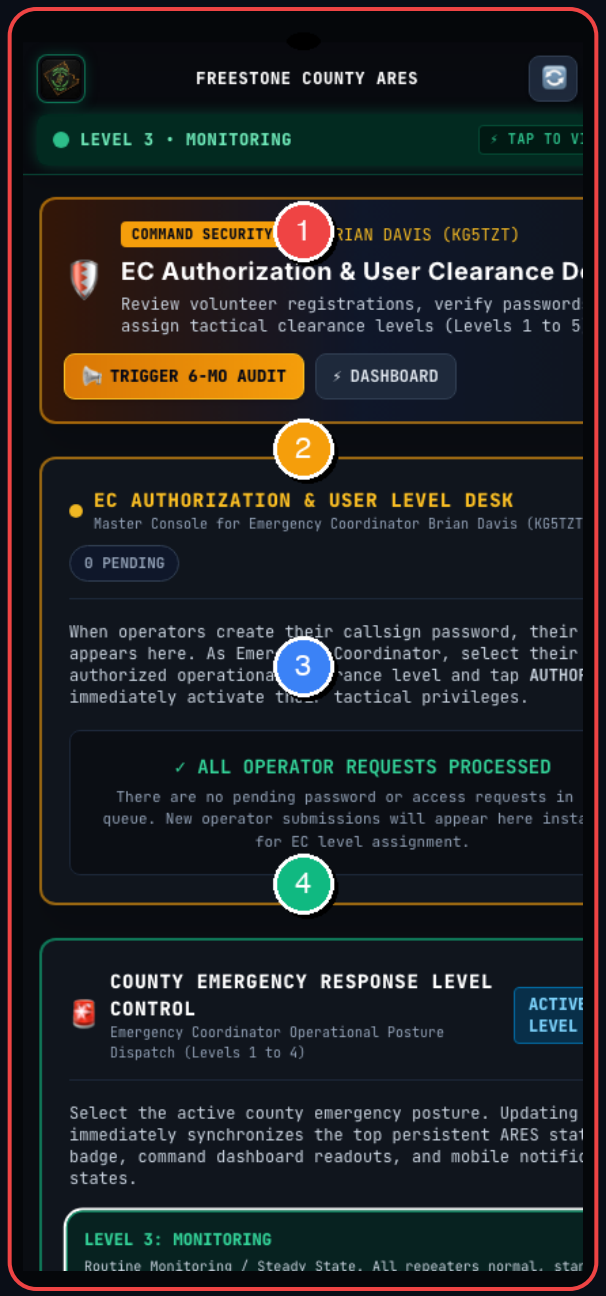
4. Tap 'PURGE EXPIRED ALERTS' to clear past incident callouts once an incident is demobilized.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Activating an alert plays a 3-tone siren on all connected member phones, ev

■■ LEADERSHIP DIRECTIVE // RESTRICTED ACCESS

AUTHORITY RESTRICTION: Only EC Brian Davis (KG5TZT) or an operator with active delegation can access this dispatch board.

EC SECURITY DESK, CLEARANCE & DELEGATION



■ WHAT THIS SCREEN IS FOR

Allows the Emergency Coordinator to authorize new volunteers, adjust operational clearance levels (1 to 5), and grant out-of-town delegation.

■ STEP-BY-STEP ACTIONS (MARINE-PROOF)

1. Badge 1 confirms administrative authority for County Emergency Coordinator Brian Davis (KG5TZT).

2. Check Badge 2 & 3: Review incoming volunteer registration requests and tap 'AUTHORIZE' to grant system credentials.

3. Check Badge 4 (COUNTY RESPONSE LEVEL CONTROL): Tap to shift county posture (Level 1 Normal, Level 2 Standby, Level 3 Active Incident).

4. Use the Out-of-Town Delegation card to temporarily delegate activation and siren authority when the EC is away.

✔ HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKED: Shifting the county response level updates the top status bar across all op

■■ LEADERSHIP DIRECTIVE // RESTRICTED ACCESS

DELEGATION RULE: When returning to Freestone County, always toggle delegation back to OFF to restore sole executive authority to KG5TZT.

EMERGENCY QUICK REFERENCE

FREESTONE COUNTY ARES COMMUNICATIONS CHEAT SHEET

EMERGENCY COORDINATOR

Brian Davis (KG5TZT) • County Emergency Coordinator

Responsible for County Activation Posture, incident command coordination, and served agency liaison.

PRIMARY REPEATER [P]

FF 110: 145.110 MHz (-600 kHz offset, TSQ 146.2 Hz)

Fairfield high-elevation tower. Primary county net operations, emergency dispatches and weekly nets.

ALTERNATE REPEATER [A]

WRTM 760: 146.760 MHz (-600 kHz offset, CTCSS Tone 136.5 Hz)

Wortham site. Secondary countywide backup when Primary repeater experienc outage or interference.

TACTICAL SIMPLEX [C]

ARES TAC: 146.580 MHz Simplex (Direct point-to-point)

Contingency method used when commercial electrical grid fails and all repeaters go dark.